PROJECT COMPLETION REPORT · MAY 2023 – APRIL 2026

INLAND FISHERY BASED LIVELIHOOD IMPROVEMENT INTERVENTION

FOR TRIBAL COMMUNITY OF POLADPUR BLOCK, RAIGAD



FUNDED BY

ATLAS COPCO (INDIA) PVT. LTD.

CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY INITIATIVE

Atlas Copco Group

IMPLEMENTED BY

SHRAMJIVI JANATA SAHAYYAK MANDAL (SJSM)

SATARA, MAHARASHTRA

SHRAMJIVI Empowering India

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May 2023 – April 2026

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ABOUT SHRAMJIVI JANATA SAHAYYAK MANDAL (SJSM)

Development NGO established 1980 · Satara, Maharashtra

SHRAMJIVI
Empowering India

SJSM is a development NGO based in Satara, Maharashtra, established in 1980 by youth from nomadic tribal communities near the Koyna Dam. It has expanded to 500+ villages across Satara, Sangli, and Raigad - promoting self-reliant, community-led development.

SJSM has promoted 60 cooperatives with 27,500+ tribal families across sectors including fisheries, dairy, food processing, SHGs, herbal cultivation, and Ayurvedic medicine. Its micro-credit cooperative has 2,525 households with an annual turnover of ₹100 million.

After the Konkan floods of 2005, SJSM initiated tribal rehabilitation and inland fisheries programs for Katkari communities, forming the Konkan Lokadhikar Manch to strengthen tribal rights and advocacy.



BACKGROUND

The Katkari tribal communities of Poladpur Taluka primarily depend on inland fisheries and wage labour. Limited access to modern fishing equipment, poor post-harvest infrastructure, and declining fish productivity restricted income opportunities for fishing families.

ABOUT THE PROJECT

The project aimed to enhance the socio-economic condition of tribal fishing communities through sustainable fisheries development, capacity building, institutional strengthening, and livelihood support interventions. Implemented across 15 tribal hamlets of Poladpur Taluka (and Mahad Block), the project focused on improving fish production, strengthening cooperatives and SHGs, promoting scientific fishery practices, and increasing access to government entitlements over three years.

15	800+	368 HH	3 YEARS	₹6.72 CR
TRIBAL HAMLETS COVERED	DIRECT BENEFICIARIES	BASELINE SURVEYED	PROJECT DURATION	TOTAL PROJECT IMPACT

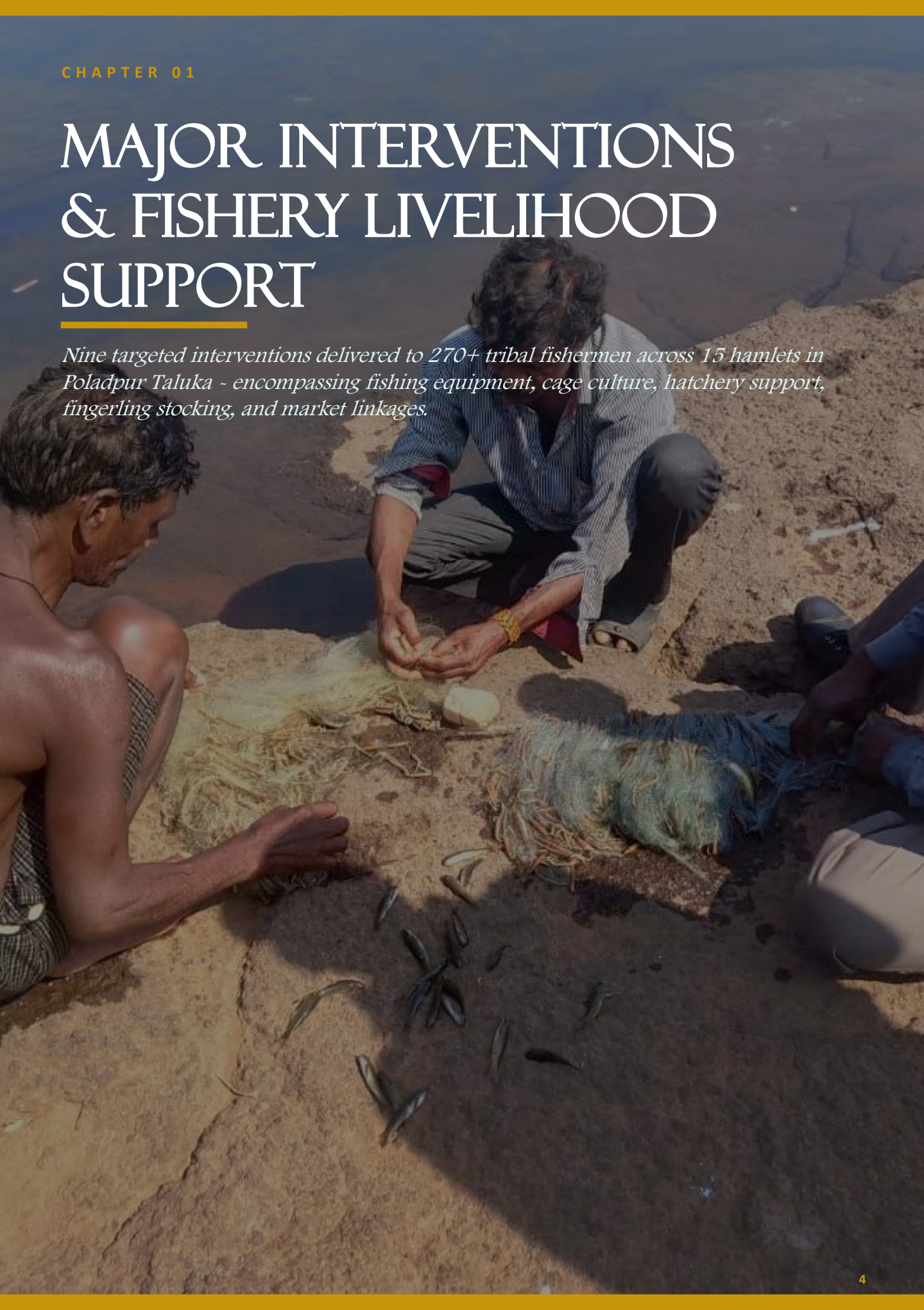
PROJECT OBJECTIVES

1. Strengthen the traditional inland fishery-based livelihood of the Katkari tribal community.
2. Develop and implement scientific fishery management models, including stocking density and culture-based capture fisheries.
3. Strengthen local fish fingerling production units to ensure sustainable fish seed availability.
4. Increase fish production per unit area, enhancing income of local tribal fishermen.
5. Improve financial management skills and cooperative governance among fisherfolk.

CHAPTER 01

MAJOR INTERVENTIONS & FISHERY LIVELIHOOD SUPPORT

Nine targeted interventions delivered to 270+ tribal fishermen across 15 hamlets in Poladpur Taluka - encompassing fishing equipment, cage culture, hatchery support, fingerling stocking, and market linkages.



A. FISHERY LIVELIHOOD SUPPORT INTERVENTIONS

Nine activities covering equipment, aquaculture, seed production, and market access



Distribution of Fishing Nets

Fishing nets distributed to fishermen & cooperative members. Training on proper usage and maintenance provided. Improved efficiency, increased catch potential, and promoted sustainable fishing practices.



River & Dam Fishing Nets

River and dam fishing nets provided to eligible fishermen, enabling expanded operations and access to new fishing areas. Reduced operational costs and improved fishing productivity.



Cage Culture Unit at Aambavade Dam

One cage culture unit established at Ambavade Reservoir. Training on cage management, fish feeding, and health monitoring. Fingerlings stocked; regular monitoring ensured healthy growth.



Distribution of Ice Boxes

Ice boxes distributed to fishing families to improve storage and transportation. Training on hygienic handling conducted. Reduced post-harvest losses and enabled better market prices.



Supply of Marketing Accessories

Marketing kits - knives, weighing scales, and plastic containers - provided to fishermen. Enhanced fish handling, storage, and marketing. Improved product quality and customer confidence.



Nurturing of Brood Stock

Quality brood stock of Catla, Rohu, Mrigal, and Cyprinus species procured under scientific management. Regular feeding and health monitoring ensured successful breeding cycles.



Stocking of Fingerlings in Reservoirs

21.5 lakh fingerlings scientifically stocked in five reservoirs over three years. Good survival and growth rates confirmed by monitoring, improving fish production and biodiversity.



Construction of Brood Stock Pond

Nutritious feed supplied to brood stock to improve growth, health, and reproductive performance. Training on feeding schedules and nutrition management enhanced breeding efficiency.



Hatchery Rearing Support

Comprehensive hatchery support through nets, haps, feed, medicines, and equipment. Improved hatchery management and larval rearing resulted in higher survival rates and increased seed production.

FISHERY PRODUCTION OPERATIONS IN DETAIL

Hatchery unit, fish seed stocking, brood stock management, and pond construction

Fish Production Unit - Hatchery Process (Spawning · Breeding · Larval Rearing · Fingerling Production)



A TOTAL OF 21.5 LAKH FINGERLINGS WERE SCIENTIFICALLY STOCKED IN 5 RESERVOIRS COVERING 242 HECTARES DURING THE PROJECT PERIOD (2023–2026), CONTRIBUTING TO IMPROVED FISH POPULATION AND BIODIVERSITY.



Fish Seed Stocking in Reservoir



Construction of Fish Brood Stock Pond

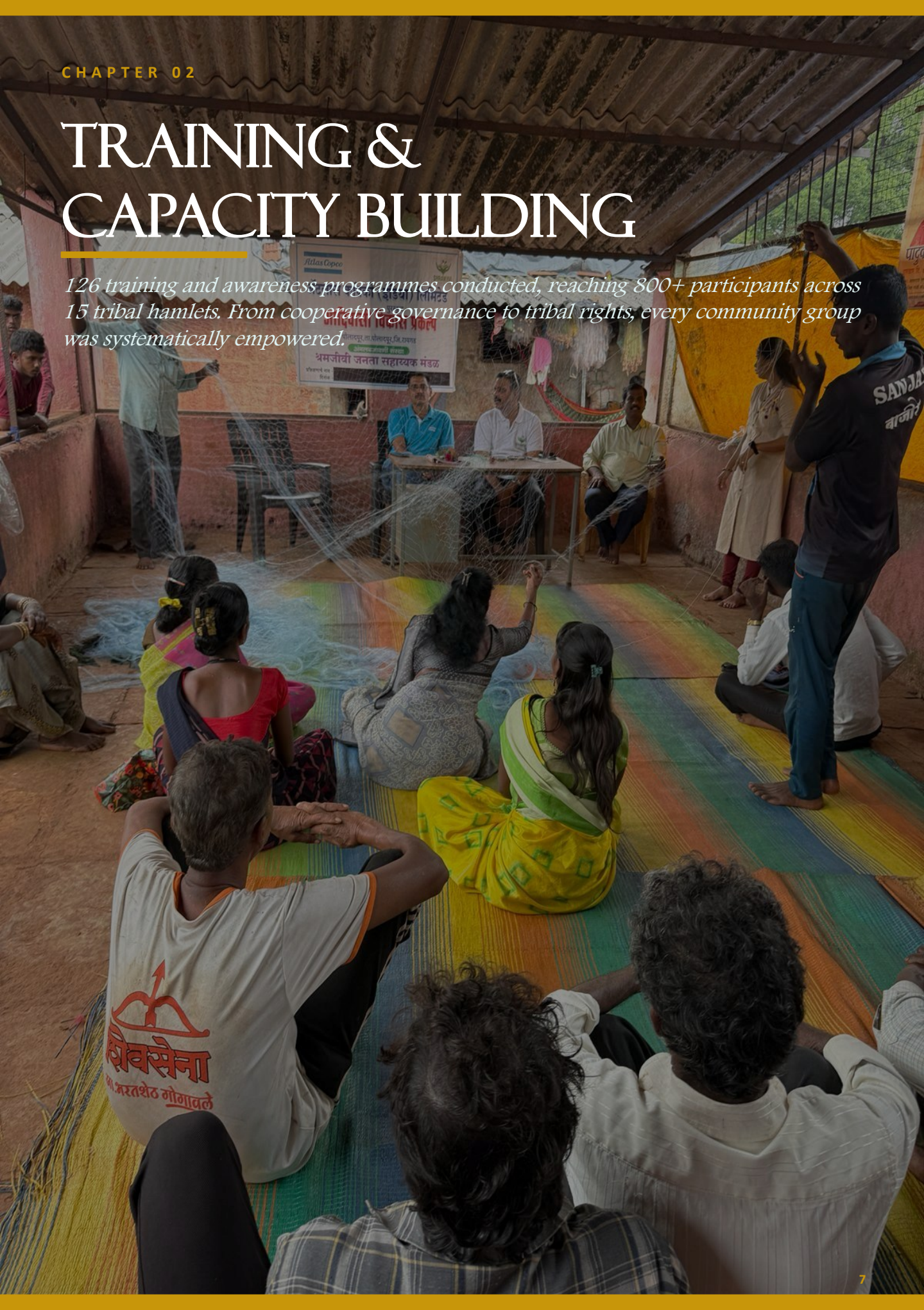
BROOD STOCK & HATCHERY SUPPORT - KEY DETAILS

Species	Catla, Rohu, Mrigal, Cyprinus (Indian major carps)
Brood Stock	1,000 kg quality brood stock procured and maintained
Feeding	12 months of nutritious feed supplied; training on schedules provided
Hatchery Input	Nets, haps, feed, medicines, and essential equipment provided
Breeding	Induced breeding, larval rearing, and health monitoring ensured high survival
Stocking	21.5 lakh fingerlings stocked in 5 reservoirs (242 ha) over 3 years

CHAPTER 02

TRAINING & CAPACITY BUILDING

126 training and awareness programmes conducted, reaching 800+ participants across 15 tribal hamlets. From cooperative governance to tribal rights, every community group was systematically empowered.



TRAINING & CAPACITY BUILDING PROGRAMMES

SYSTEMATIC STRENGTHENING OF FISHERMEN, SHGS, COOPERATIVES, AND COMMUNITY LEADERS

126 TRAINING PROGRAMMES

800+ PARTICIPANTS REACHED

15 SHGS STRENGTHENED

300+ FISHERMEN SENSITIZED

343 KATKARI MEMBERS REACHED

#	Programme	Reach & Scale	Key Outcomes
1	Awareness on Sustainable Fishing Practices	45 camps · 300+ fishermen & Community Members 15 Tribal hamlets	Eco-friendly practices, compliance with seasonal bans, aquatic ecosystem conservation awareness.
2	Fishing Cooperative Member Training	12 programmes · 16 cooperative members trained	Enhanced governance, financial management, leadership, and adoption of modern fishing techniques.
3	Micro-Credit Cooperative Member Training	12 programmes · 20 cooperative members trained	Improved financial literacy, bookkeeping, credit management, and entrepreneurship skills.
4	SHG Capacity Building	6 programmes · 89 participants · 15 SHGs strengthened (4 new + 4 revived)	Enhanced credit access, government scheme linkages, and women's economic empowerment.
5	River Fishing Beneficiary Training	6 programmes · 32 fishermen from 42 tribal wadis	Improved fishing techniques, fish preservation, post-harvest management, river conservation.
6	Fishing Cooperative EC Members	18 sessions · 11 EC members trained	Strengthened governance, financial oversight, fisheries management, and leadership.
7	Micro-Credit Cooperative & Village Leaders	18 sessions · 15 EC + 20 village leaders	Improved decision-making, governance, financial management, and community mobilization.
8	Katkari Adivasi Aadhaar Sanghatna (KAAS)	9 programmes · 32 KAAS + 343 community members	Tribal rights awareness, government welfare schemes, social entitlements, community leadership.







KEY CAPACITY BUILDING ACHIEVEMENTS AT A GLANCE

- 126 training and awareness programmes conducted during the project period across all activity areas.
- Over 800 participants reached through awareness camps, training programmes, and community meetings.
- 15 SHGs strengthened, including 4 newly formed SHGs and 4 revived inactive groups across tribal hamlets.
- 16 fishing cooperative members, 20 micro-credit cooperative members, 11 fisheries cooperative EC members trained.
- 15 micro-credit EC members, 20 village leaders, 32 river fishing beneficiaries, and 32 KAAS members directly trained.
- 300+ fishermen sensitized on sustainable fishing practices, seasonal restrictions, and resource conservation.
- 343 Katkari community members engaged through KAAS strengthening and rights-based awareness initiatives.

GLIMPSES OF TRAINING ACTIVITIES

Baseline survey, awareness camps, SHG meetings, and capacity building sessions


Baseline Survey


Awareness Camp


Community Meeting


Training Session


SHG Capacity Building


Women's Meeting


Expert Training


Fisheries Training


Health Check-up Camp


Expert Capacity Building


Community Leader Training

MAJOR ACHIEVEMENT OF PROJECT - SUMMARY TABLE

Ten key milestones achieved during May 2023 to April 2026

#	Activity	Major Milestone	Key Outcome
1	Baseline Survey	368 HH surveyed across 15 wadis	Household profiles created, documentation gaps identified, and support for accessing government schemes.
2	Dam Fishing Nets	83 fishermen supported	Increased fish catch, improved fishing efficiency, and enhanced income generation.
3	River Fishing Nets	213 fishermen supported	Expanded fishing coverage, reduced operational costs, and improved livelihoods.
4	Cage Culture Units	4 cage culture units installed	Promoted aquaculture, ensured year-round fish production, and created a sustainable income source.
5	Ice Boxes	25 SHG members supported	Reduced post-harvest losses, improved fish quality, and increased market value.
6	Marketing Accessory Kits	25 kits distributed	Improved fish handling, hygiene, weighing accuracy, and marketing efficiency.
7	Brood Stock Procurement	1,000 kg brood stock procured	Strengthened fish breeding, seed production, and long-term fish stock sustainability.
8	Fingerling Stocking	21.5 lakh in 5 reservoirs (242 ha) over 3 years	Enhanced fish population, improved biodiversity, and increased fisher incomes.
9	Brood Stock Feed	Feed provided for 12 months	Improved fish growth, breeding performance, and hatchery productivity.
10	Hatchery Rearing Support	Nets, haps, feed, medicines, equipment provided	Increased fish seed production, reduced mortality, and strengthened hatchery operations.

OVERALL: THESE FISHERY LIVELIHOOD INTERVENTIONS SIGNIFICANTLY STRENGTHENED TRIBAL FISHING COMMUNITIES - IMPROVING FISH PRODUCTION, REDUCING POST-HARVEST LOSSES, AND CONTRIBUTING TO GREATER INCOME AND ECONOMIC RESILIENCE.

IMPACT ON FISHERIES-BASED LIVELIHOODS

During the three-year project period (2023–2026), a total of 270 fishermen directly benefited from fisheries-based livelihood interventions. Together, they harvested 1,20,552 kg of fish, generating a cumulative income of ₹1.89 Crore.

270
DIRECT BENEFICIARIES

1,20,552 KG
TOTAL FISH PRODUCTION

₹1.89 CRORE
TOTAL INCOME GENERATED

FISHERIES INCOME GENERATED DURING THE PROJECT

Category-wise breakdown of fish production and income earned

Category	Beneficiaries	Fish Production	Avg. Rate	Income Generated
River Fishing Beneficiaries	198	68,406 kg	₹155/kg	₹1,06,02,930
Dam Fishing Beneficiaries	72	52,146 kg	₹160/kg	₹83,43,360
TOTAL	**270**	**1,20,552 kg**	-	**₹1,89,46,290**

KEY IMPACT ACHIEVED

- 270 tribal fishermen secured sustainable livelihood opportunities through project interventions.
- 1.20 lakh kg of fish production achieved during the project period across 5 reservoirs.
- Total income of ₹1.89 Crore generated - ₹1.06 Cr from river fishing + ₹83.4 L from dam fishing.
- Improved fishing equipment, stocking, and training enhanced productivity and catch efficiency.
- Increased fish availability strengthened local markets and improved household food security.
- Project contributed to greater economic resilience and improved living standards among tribal families.



Fisherman in Active Fishing - River Catch



Fish Catch at Market - Post-Harvest

CHAPTER 03

POLADPUR BLOCK DEEP DIVE

Comprehensive coverage of interventions, capacity building, government scheme access, and community transformation specifically in Poladpur block - the primary project area.



POLADPUR BLOCK - PROJECT FOOTPRINT & OUTCOMES

Primary project block · 15 tribal hamlets · Raigad district, Maharashtra

15	213	83	485	₹3.05 CR
HAMLETS COVERED	RIVER NET BENEFICIARIES	DAM NET BENEFICIARIES	GOVT. SCHEME BENEFICIARIES	SCHEME BENEFITS

INTERVENTIONS IN POLADPUR BLOCK

1 Fishing Net Distribution

Dam nets for 83 fishermen; river nets for 213 fishermen from 15 tribal wadis. Training on proper usage and sustainable practices.

2 Fingerling Stocking

21.5 lakh fingerlings stocked across 5 reservoirs (242 ha) - Poladpur being the primary area. Good survival rates documented.

3 Ice Boxes & Marketing

25 ice boxes to SHG members; 25 marketing kits distributed. Post-harvest losses reduced significantly.

4 Health Camp

Health check-up camps conducted for tribal fishing families - benefiting community wellbeing.


Net Distribution Event


Fish Stocking Activity


Health Camp

GOVERNMENT SCHEME ACCESS - POLADPUR BLOCK: 485 BENEFICIARIES · ₹3.05 CRORE IN BENEFITS · INCLUDES PMAY HOUSING (116 FAMILIES), SHABARI AWAS YOJANA (18 FAMILIES), 257 CASTE CERTIFICATES, MSRLM REVOLVING FUNDS.

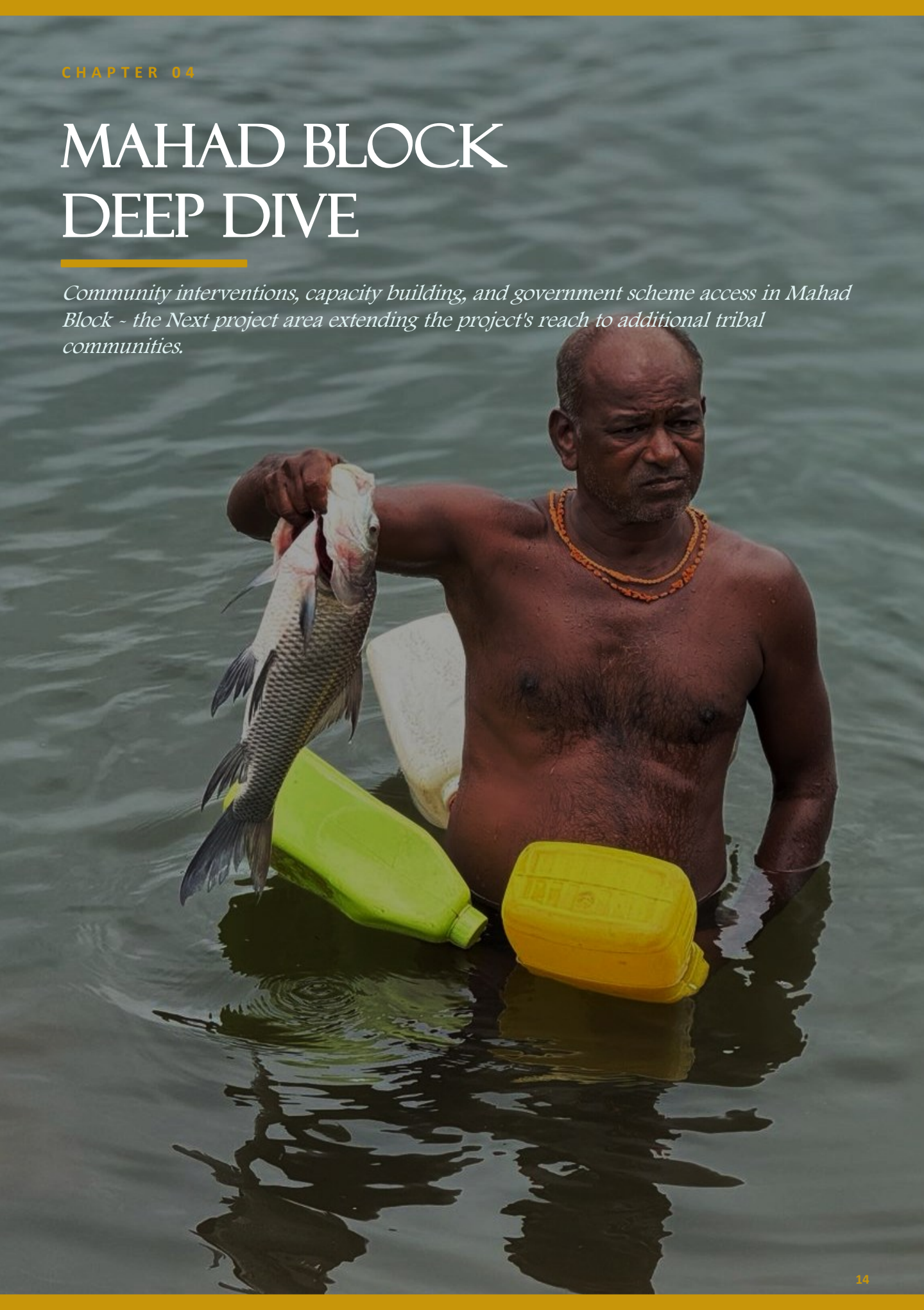

Distribution of Fishing Equipment - Poladpur


Fingerling Transportation for Stocking

CHAPTER 04

MAHAD BLOCK DEEP DIVE

Community interventions, capacity building, and government scheme access in Mahad Block - the Next project area extending the project's reach to additional tribal communities.



MAHAD BLOCK - PROJECT FOOTPRINT & OUTCOMES

Next project block · Raigad district, Maharashtra

235	₹1.78 CR	62	22	300+
GOVT. SCHEME BENEFICIARIES	SCHEME BENEFITS	PMAY HOUSING FAMILIES	SHABARI AWAS FAMILIES	FISHERMEN SENSITIZED

INTERVENTIONS & ACTIVITIES IN MAHAD BLOCK

The Mahad Block was covered as the Next project area, extending the reach of the fisheries livelihood intervention to additional tribal communities. Key activities included awareness campaigns, training for fishermen and SHG members, capacity building of village leaders, and facilitation of access to government welfare schemes.
Through continuous awareness campaigns and handholding support by SJSM, 235 beneficiaries from Mahad Block accessed government welfare schemes worth ₹1.78 Crore during the project period.


Community Gathering - Mahad

Awareness Camp - Mahad Block

SHG Meeting in Mahad Block

Capacity Building - Mahad

GOVERNMENT SCHEME ACCESS - MAHAD BLOCK

PMAY HOUSING
62 FAMILIES RECEIVED HOUSING SUPPORT UNDER PRADHAN MANTRI AWAS YOJANA

SHABARI AWAS YOJANA
22 FAMILIES BENEFITED FROM THIS TRIBAL HOUSING SCHEME

CASTE CERTIFICATES
BENEFICIARIES SUPPORTED TO OBTAIN CASTE CERTIFICATES AND RATION CARDS

POULTRY UNITS
POULTRY UNITS PROVIDED TO BENEFICIARIES FOR INCOME DIVERSIFICATION

UJJWALA GAS
UJJWALA LPG GAS CONNECTIONS EXTENDED TO ELIGIBLE BENEFICIARIES

COMMUNITY INFRASTRUCTURE
SUPPORT FOR COMMUNITY INFRASTRUCTURE AND SANITATION IMPROVEMENT

MAHAD BLOCK IMPACT: 235 BENEFICIARIES ACCESSED GOVERNMENT SCHEMES WORTH ₹1.78 CRORE - INCLUDING HOUSING, LIVELIHOOD ASSETS, LPG CONNECTIONS, AND CASTE CERTIFICATES.


E-Rickshaw Distribution - Govt. Scheme


Solar Panel Distribution - Mahad

GOVERNMENT SCHEME ACCESS & SOCIAL ENTITLEMENTS - POLADPUR BLOCK

*485 beneficiaries · **Schemes worth ₹3.05 Crore** · 2023–2026*

One of the most significant outcomes of the project was the increased awareness among tribal communities regarding their rights, government welfare schemes, and the importance of possessing essential documents. Through continuous awareness campaigns, training programmes, community meetings, and handholding support provided by SJSM, beneficiaries were able to access a range of government welfare schemes and social security benefits.

PMAY HOUSING SUPPORT

116

116 FAMILIES FROM TRIBAL HAMLETS RECEIVED HOUSING SUPPORT UNDER PRADHAN MANTRI AWAS YOJANA (PMAY). THIS TRANSFORMATIVE INTERVENTION PROVIDED CONCRETE HOMES TO FAMILIES PREVIOUSLY LIVING IN KUTCHA STRUCTURES.

SHABARI AWAS YOJANA

18

18 FAMILIES BENEFITED FROM SHABARI AWAS YOJANA - A STATE-LEVEL TRIBAL HOUSING SCHEME. COMBINED WITH PMAY, THIS SCHEME PROVIDED COMPREHENSIVE HOUSING COVERAGE TO ELIGIBLE TRIBAL FAMILIES.

CASTE CERTIFICATES

257

257 BENEFICIARIES OBTAINED CASTE CERTIFICATES, ENABLING ACCESS TO VARIOUS TRIBAL WELFARE SCHEMES, EDUCATIONAL BENEFITS, JOB RESERVATIONS, AND GOVERNMENT ENTITLEMENTS PREVIOUSLY INACCESSIBLE WITHOUT DOCUMENTATION.

MSRLM REVOLVING FUND

40

40 WOMEN MEMBERS FROM 4 SELF-HELP GROUPS RECEIVED REVOLVING FUND SUPPORT THROUGH MAHARASHTRA STATE RURAL LIVELIHOODS MISSION (MSRLM), ENHANCING FINANCIAL INCLUSION AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP.

TOTAL SCHEME BENEFICIARIES

485

BENEFICIARIES ALSO ACCESSED UJJWALA GAS CONNECTIONS, AYUSHMAN BHARAT CARDS, AND ELECTRICITY CONNECTIONS - COLLECTIVELY IMPROVING QUALITY OF LIFE ACROSS 15 TRIBAL HAMLETS IN POLADPUR ₹3.05 CRORE



Equipment Distribution



educational material support



Solar Power Scheme



community infrastructure schemes

MAHAD BLOCK SCHEME ACCESS & SOCIAL WELFARE INFRASTRUCTURE SUPPORT

235 beneficiaries · ₹1.78 Crore · Plus social welfare linkages across both blocks



GOVERNMENT SCHEME DISTRIBUTION - COMMUNITY EMPOWERMENT EVENT

Scheme	Beneficiaries / Units	Value / Benefit	Impact
PMAY - Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana	62 families	Housing grant	Permanent concrete homes for tribal families
Shabari Awas Yojana	22 families	State housing grant	Tribal housing scheme; complementary to PMAY
Caste Certificates	Multiple beneficiaries	Documentation	Access to reservations, schemes, and entitlements
Ration Cards	Multiple beneficiaries	Food security	Access to PDS and subsidized food provisions
Poultry Units	Multiple beneficiaries	Livelihood asset	Income diversification beyond fishing activities
Ujjwala LPG Connections	Multiple beneficiaries	Clean cooking fuel	Reduced indoor smoke; women's health improvement
Community Infrastructure	9 hamlets	Satranji + furniture support	Physical assets for community meeting spaces
Educational Materials	9 hamlets	Furniture + supplies	Support for schools and educational infrastructure
Solar Power Scheme	5 hamlets	Solar installations	Renewable energy access for tribal hamlets

ADDITIONAL SOCIAL WELFARE INFRASTRUCTURE LINKAGES

- E-rickshaw units provided for livelihood transportation
- Sugarcane juice extraction machines for income generation
- Open gym equipment installed in tribal hamlets
- Community business infrastructure support extended
- Solar power scheme covered 5 hamlets across both blocks

MEDIA COVERAGE - PROJECT IN THE NEWS

Project activities gained significant media attention in local and regional newspapers

The project's community activities, government scheme distributions, and tribal empowerment initiatives received coverage in local Marathi newspapers, reflecting the public significance and community recognition of SJSM's work in Poladpur and Mahad blocks.



पोलादपूरमध्ये आदिवासी बांधव एकवटले

२३ वाड्यामधील समाज बांधव उपस्थित

Marathi Newspaper Coverage - Poladpur Tribal Fisheries Project



शब्दांना सत्याची धार

प्रहार

सावित्री आदिवासी सहकारी पतसंस्थेतर्फे आदिवासी आदिशक्ती मेळावा संपन्न

◆ पोलादपूर (प्रतिनिधी):

Mumbai Edition

'Prahar' Newspaper - Project Activities Coverage



पुढारी

श्रमजीवीचा मत्स्यउद्योग - आदिवासींसाठी नवसंजीवनी !

रोजगाराबरोबरच मिळाले आर्थिक, सामाजिक बळ

Pudhari Newspaper - SJSM Tribal Empowerment Coverage

MEDIA COVERAGE IN 'PUDHARI', 'PRAHAR', AND LOCAL MARATHI NEWSPAPERS HIGHLIGHTED THE TRANSFORMATIVE IMPACT OF FISHERIES INTERVENTIONS AND GOVERNMENT SCHEME ACCESS FOR KATKARI TRIBAL COMMUNITIES.

CHAPTER 05

SUCCESS STORIES COMMUNITY VOICES

Three documented stories of transformation - a tribal fisherwoman, a 172-member cooperative, and a cage culture pioneer - demonstrating the human impact behind the numbers.



SUCCESS STORY 1

"FROM DAILY STRUGGLES TO SUSTAINABLE SUCCESS"

RANJANA PAWAR · FISHER WOMAN & COOPERATIVE MEMBER · POLADPUR TALUKA



BACKGROUND

Ranjana Pawar has been engaged in fishing activities along with her family for many years as a member of the local fishing cooperative. Fishing served as the primary income source for her household. However, limited access to quality fishing equipment, inadequate post-harvest facilities, and fluctuating fish catch resulted in irregular earnings and financial uncertainty.

CHALLENGES

Like many fisher families in the region, Ranjana faced difficulties maintaining stable income due to traditional fishing methods, post-harvest losses, and limited market opportunities. The lack of proper storage facilities often affected fish quality and reduced the selling price of her catch, compounding financial stress on the household.

PROJECT INTERVENTION

Under the Fisheries Livelihood Development Project by Atlas Copco India and SJSM, Ranjana received support through various livelihood enhancement initiatives. She participated in training on sustainable fishing practices, fish handling, marketing, and resource conservation. Improved fishing equipment and post-harvest support were facilitated.

CHANGE ACHIEVED: MORE REGULAR EARNINGS, REDUCED POST-HARVEST LOSSES, ABILITY TO SELL FISH AT IMPROVED PRICES. ENHANCED FINANCIAL SECURITY AND REDUCED DEPENDENCE ON SEASONAL WAGE LABOUR. RANJANA IS NOW A CONFIDENT, ACTIVE COOPERATIVE MEMBER.

> *"The training and support provided through the project helped me improve my fishing activities and earn a more stable income. Today, I feel more confident about supporting my family through fishing.*
>
> **- Ranjana Pawar, Fisherwoman and Cooperative Member, Poladpur**

SUCCESS STORY 2

"PRESERVING THE CATCH, SECURING THE FUTURE"

Adiwasi Machhimar V.K. Sahakari Sanstha, Gadital - 172 Members · near Bajire Dam, Poladpur

SOCIETY PROFILE

SOCIETY NAME:	ADIWASI MACHHIMAR V.K. SAHAKARI SANSTHA, MARYA GADITAL	MEMBERS:	172 ACTIVE MEMBERS
CHAIRMAN:	MR. KASHINATH TUKARAM PAWAR	SECRETARY:	MR. PANDURANG SITARAM WAGHE
LOCATION:	GADITAL VILLAGE, NEAR BAJIRE DAM	ACTIVITY:	INLAND FISHING AS PRIMARY LIVELIHOOD



Ice Box Distribution Event - Adiwasi Machhimar V.K. Sahakari Sanstha, Gadital

THE CHALLENGE

Members of the cooperative regularly ventured into Bajire Dam reservoir to catch fish. However, due to the perishable nature of fish and the absence of cold storage facilities, unsold fish often spoiled within a day, resulting in financial losses. Fishermen were forced to sell at whatever price local traders offered.

PROJECT INTERVENTION

Under the project, Atlas Copco India and SJSM provided ice boxes to members of the fishing community. Training was conducted on hygienic fish handling, storage practices, and effective use of ice boxes to improve fish preservation and reduce post-harvest losses.

IMPACT OF CHANGE

Fish can now be stored safely for longer periods, reducing spoilage. Fishermen gained flexibility to sell in nearby and distant markets, securing better prices. Dependence on local middlemen reduced, bargaining power strengthened, and income stability increased for all 172 members.

> *"Earlier, we had to sell fish immediately, often at whatever price was offered. With the ice boxes provided through the project, we can preserve our fish, access better markets, and earn better incomes. Our hard work now brings better returns."*
>
> **- Member, Adiwasi Machhimar V.K. Sahakari Sanstha, Gadital**

SUCCESS STORY 3

"INNOVATING FISHERIES, SECURING FUTURES"

Cage Culture Initiative · Aambavade Dam · Adiwasi Machhimar V.K. Sahakari Sanstha



Cage Culture System at Aambavade Dam - Full View



Cage Frame Installation Process - Community Participation

Background

The fishing community around Aambavade Dam depends primarily on fisheries for its livelihood. Declining fish availability, seasonal fluctuations, and limited access to modern aquaculture practices resulted in unstable incomes. Traditional fishing methods were insufficient due to declining fish stocks and seasonal uncertainties.

Project Intervention

Atlas Copco India provided CSR support and SJSM facilitated the establishment of a Cage Culture Unit at Aambavade Dam. Activities included: installation of fish cages, stocking of commercially valuable fish species, and technical training on cage management, feeding practices, water quality monitoring, and fish health management.

Change Achieved

- Established a functional cage culture unit at Aambavade Dam
- Enhanced fish production through scientific aquaculture practices
- Improved technical knowledge and skills of cooperative members
- Created a sustainable income source beyond traditional fishing

> *Cage culture has opened a new avenue of income for our cooperative. With the training and support received through the project, we are now confident about adopting modern fish farming practices and building a better future for our families.*
>
> **- Member, Adiwasi Machhimar V.K. Sahakari Sanstha, Aambavade**



Cage Frame



Cage System



Operational Cage

THE CAGE CULTURE INITIATIVE DEMONSTRATED HOW INNOVATIVE FISHERIES INTERVENTIONS CAN TRANSFORM TRADITIONAL LIVELIHOODS INTO SUSTAINABLE INCOME-GENERATING OPPORTUNITIES FOR TRIBAL COMMUNITIES.

CUMULATIVE PROJECT IMPACT - MAY 2023 TO APRIL 2026

Comprehensive outcomes across fisheries, government schemes, training, and community development

21.5 LAKH
Fingerlings Stocked
(5 reservoirs, 242 ha)

₹1.89 CR
Fisheries Income
Generated

₹4.83 CR
Govt. Scheme
Benefits

720
Govt. Scheme
Beneficiaries

126
Training
Programmes

800+
Participants
Reached

BLOCK-WISE IMPACT COMPARISON

INDICATOR	POLADPUR BLOCK	MAHAD BLOCK	TOTAL
GOVT. SCHEME BENEFICIARIES	485	235	720
GOVT. SCHEME BENEFITS	₹3.05 CRORE	₹1.78 CRORE	₹4.83 CRORE
PMAY HOUSING FAMILIES	116 FAMILIES	62 FAMILIES	178 FAMILIES
SHABARI AWAS FAMILIES	18 FAMILIES	22 FAMILIES	40 FAMILIES
CASTE CERTIFICATES	257 BENEFICIARIES	MULTIPLE	257+

FISHERIES LIVELIHOOD IMPACT

CATEGORY	BENEFICIARIE	FISH PRODUCTION	MARKET RATE	INCOME GENERATED
RIVER FISHING	198	68,406 KG	₹155/KG	₹1,06,02,930
DAM FISHING	72	52,146 KG	₹160/KG	₹83,43,360
TOTAL	270	1,20,552 KG	-	₹1,89,46,290

WAY FORWARD & RECOMMENDATIONS

In conclusion, the project has successfully boosted fishery-based livelihoods, enhancing income and community resilience. To ensure year-round self-reliance, additional support is needed to diversify livelihoods through small-scale enterprises and animal husbandry.

Extend Project Support

Provide **two additional year** of funding to diversify livelihoods through small-scale enterprises and animal husbandry, ensuring year-round income stability for Katkari tribal families in both blocks.

Replicate the Fishery Model

Scale the successful fishery model to adjacent Mahad and Mangaon blocks, empowering additional tribal communities toward sustainable, self-sufficient futures based on proven intervention strategies.

Strengthen Institutions

Continue capacity building of fishing cooperatives, SHGs, and community organizations to ensure long-term self-management, governance, and financial sustainability beyond the project period.

State Partnership Linkages

Explore formal linkages with Maharashtra state fisheries departments, NABARD, and government programmes for continued technical support, policy integration, and resource mobilization.

BY EXPANDING PROVEN INTERVENTIONS TO MAHAD AND MANGAON BLOCKS, WE CAN EMPOWER MORE TRIBAL COMMUNITIES TOWARD SUSTAINABLE AND SELF-SUFFICIENT FUTURES - BUILDING ON THE DEMONSTRATED SUCCESS OF THIS THREE-YEAR MODEL.





CONCLUSION

THREE YEARS OF TRANSFORMATIVE IMPACT

The Inland Fishery Based Livelihood Improvement Intervention, implemented by Shramjivi Janata Sahayyak Mandal (SJSM) with CSR support from Atlas Copco (India) Pvt. Ltd., has achieved significant milestones in improving the livelihoods, institutional capacities, and socio-economic conditions of Katkari tribal fishing communities in Poladpur Taluka and Mahad Block, Raigad district.

Over three years (May 2023 – April 2026), the project has demonstrated that targeted investments in fisheries development - combining livelihood support, scientific fisheries management, capacity building, and institutional strengthening - can create lasting impact for marginalized tribal communities.

> *Together, we have demonstrated that sustainable development is achievable when communities, NGOs, and the private sector work in partnership toward a shared vision of inclusive growth. This project stands as a testament to what collective action and genuine partnership can achieve.*

IMPLEMENTED BY

SHRAMJIVI JANATA SAHAYYAK MANDAL (SJSM), SATARA

Established 1980 · Maharashtra

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Corporate Social Responsibility Initiative

Project Period: May 2023 – April 2026

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